device” and why it obeyed different rules than the quantum world, Heisenberg was infuriatingly unclear. Nowhere in his lectures did he propose anything like a solution to the measurement problem.

But Heisenberg also made sure to leave very little daylight between his own views and Bohr’s in his talk. “Since the spring of 1927 one has had a consistent interpretation of quantum theory, which is frequently called the ‘Copenhagen interpretation.’” It was an exaggeration, at best, to claim that there had been a single consistent interpretation of quantum physics since 1927—and it was certainly not true that anything whatsoever was “frequently” called the Copenhagen interpretation at the time. In fact, Heisenberg himself had coined the phrase just a few months earlier, in an essay he had written for Bohr’s seventieth birthday. In both his essay and his lecture, Heisenberg depicted the Copenhagen interpretation as a unified body of work that was developed by Bohr, himself, and a handful of others in 1927—and in both essay and lecture, Heisenberg took it upon himself to defend the Copenhagen interpretation against its enemies. “Many attempts have been made to criticize the Copenhagen interpretation and to replace it by one more in line with the concepts of classical physics or materialistic philosophy,” Heisenberg warned his audience in Scotland. But, he claimed, this was simply impossible—ruled out entirely by the astonishing success of quantum physics, which could only be interpreted in One True Way, the Copenhagen interpretation.

The phrase “Copenhagen interpretation” was new, but this was hardly the first time that someone who had worked in Copenhagen claimed there was only one way to interpret quantum physics. Yet Heisenberg had extra reason to paint himself as an architect and defender of the quantum orthodoxy now. A common enemy had mended relations between the UK and Germany, and Heisenberg was likely hoping to perform the same kind of maneuver. Heisenberg’s appalling activities during the war had nearly destroyed his relationships with Bohr and the rest of his colleagues. But the crucible of war had also radically reshaped physics itself—and luckily for Heisenberg and his precious reputation, these dizzying changes had made physicists much more receptive to the Copenhagen interpretation.